

BEAU

The Family You Find

By Tyler Fortenberry

Dedicated to the boys without fathers, who will still grow up to be good men.

Forever grateful for my kids who believed in me and urged me to finish this.

Thank you to the theatre kids who gave me a home.

A special thanks to everyone who encouraged me.

CAST

Beau	Male. A writer.
Tristan	Male. Beau's alter ego, friend, and rock.
Olivia	Female. The mom of the department.
Dorian	Male. The dad of the department.
Lucas	Male. A mediocre actor seeking new opportunity.
Chip	Male. A lover.
Bella	Female. A student from the rival high school.

Ensemble

The Tragedians Male & Female, 10-20. Brutish. Animalistic. Child-like. Hyenas.

Notes

Dorian plays Beau's 50-year-old dad in the beginning.

SCENE I A SMALL MAN

A black space. Nothing at all.

The ensemble surrounds a boy and his father. Beau and Dorian. The Tragedians look to Beau, then to one another. They hum a made up hymn for him. Beau stands there, fists balled and jaw clenched. Dorian stands tall, ready to take on his son.

BEAU

You're cruel!

The Tragedians beat the ground.

BEAU (CONT'D)

You soiled her and you think that makes you a big man...

The Tragedians beat the ground twice.

BEAU (CONT'D)

I love her. I don't know you.

DORIAN

I work hard so that she can have more time with you. You're a sorry son. Ungrateful. You and her both. Always wanting more. Never getting enough. You're bleeding me bone dry and have got the audacity to ask for more.

BEAU

I have to beg for what I need, not that you know how to provide it.

DORIAN

(steaming)

I have always provided you with exactly what you need when you needed it.

The Tragedians beat the ground three times.

BEAU

You provide us with things so you can dangle all of it precariously over our heads. So you can taunt us, demand our love, and lash us with malice.

DORIAN

I've never asked for anything but respect from you. I give you grace/

BEAU

Oh, that's rich coming from you. A man who doesn't know God giving out grace like it's his gift to the world. Is that what you tell your friends at work? That you give grace to your ungrateful son.

DORIAN

I tell them exactly who you are. I tell them it was her that raised you, not me. You aren't the boy I wanted.

BEAU

You didn't want me at all. I asked you before what you thought I'd become when you held me. That very first time.

DORIAN

Nothin.

BEAU

You didn't think at all. **Nothin** went through your head. You take my accomplishments and pass them off as yours to make yourself look like a good man. A wonderful father. You want people to love you as you please and do as you say.

DORIAN

You **will** do as I say.

The Tragedians beat the ground.

BEAU

I say as you do because you've got no interest, no ability, to give that love back.

(MORE)

BEAU (CONT'D)

You cry out into the wind asking why it doesn't bend and shape itself around your body. You're just a small man in a big world that wished it revolved around you.

DORIAN

And one day it's going to eat you up and spit you out.

The Tragedians beat the ground twice.

BEAU

Who are you to say that?

The Tragedians beat the ground three times.

BEAU (CONT'D)

You don't know the first thing about me...

The Tragedians continuously beat the ground.

BEAU (CONT'D)

You don't care what I am. What I do. Where I go. What I become. What I dream. Who I love—

The Tragedians cease. Beau screams in rage and shoves Dorian out of the light. The ensemble scuttles away and hides. Beau seethes through his teeth and looks around. He is utterly alone. He finds a blanket outside of the light. It's a piece of his childhood. He hugs the blanket. He cries and brings his legs close to him. Tristan enters and sits next to Beau. Tristan takes him in his arms and combs his hair.

TRISTAN

We're fine. He won't follow us. He's there, and we're here. It's new.

BEAU

I don't like it. It looks poor. It smells weird. Mom is quiet. She won't speak.

TRISTAN

It's been a week.

BEAU

She's meek.

TRISTAN

You're mean.

BEAU

I know.

(beat)

I'm not a good person. I've done bad things here already.

TRISTAN

And I wasn't surprised when you did them. That doesn't make you a bad person.

BEAU

I can't hear out of my ears. Is this my punishment?

TRISTAN

Just smile when people say something.

BEAU

I can't even catch their names.

TRISTAN

They haven't bothered to ask yours. Why should you learn theirs?

BEAU

Because I need friends. I need a family. I moved here to start my life.

TRISTAN

And you will.

(brings Beau face to face)

We're going to find ourselves here. We'll make friends. We'll fall in love. We'll find a passion and figure out what makes us tick. The harvest is plenty and we're a dedicated worker. We're strong— tough as nails, and tall as giants. We've got strength as high and love as wide as a mountain range. You're gonna change the world.

BEAU

I can't change nothin. I can't even save myself.

TRISTAN

If no one cares, and the weight of the world's not shared, it's all gonna come crashing down. Maybe you can't save, but you're brave. You care. You'll change a piece of it.

Tristan stands and looks around.

BEAU

Is this the part where you leave just like everyone else?

TRISTAN

No. Not today. Not ever.

BEAU

I still don't like it here.

TRISTAN

I think it'll do. A place to start anew. Why don't you get rid of that blanket?

BEAU

Because... because I need a piece of home.

(inhales)

And it smells like her. I'll get rid of it when I'm ready.

TRISTAN

That's fair.

(holds out his hand)

I think it's high time we meet them. Start fresh. Learn what it means to care about something bigger than ourselves. That's what it means to have a family, isn't it?

Beau grabs Tristan's hand. He wraps the blanket around his shoulders and they exit.